

CV Review: Marcus Silva

Overall Score: 46/100 — Weak

Verdict: Real, multi-year web development experience is buried under casual formatting, zero quantification, and content that doesn't support a full-stack target.

Assumed target: Full-stack developer, full-time position (confirmed with candidate).

Score Summary

Category	Weight	Score	Band
ATS Compatibility	20%	50	Weak
Content Quality	20%	42	Weak
Impact	15%	28	Poor
Grammar & Spelling	15%	68	Adequate
Readability	10%	45	Weak
Visual / Layout	10%	48	Weak
Professionalism	10%	35	Poor
Overall	100%	46	Weak

Category Breakdown

ATS Compatibility — 50/100

The PDF has a real text layer (it extracts cleanly), which is the one thing working in its favor. Everything else works against it:

- Non-standard section headers: **"Where I've Worked"**, **"Stuff I Know"**, **"Things I Built"**. ATS parsers look for standard labels like "Experience," "Skills," "Projects" to bucket content correctly — cute headers risk sections being dropped or mis-tagged entirely.
- The Freelance Web Developer role is a single dense paragraph with no bullets — parsers extract discrete achievement lines far more reliably than prose blocks.
- Skills are dumped into one comma-separated run mixing hard skills, soft skills, and OS names — this dilutes keyword density exactly where an ATS keyword match matters most.
- Missing the vocabulary a full-stack req actually scans for: no "REST API," no named backend framework, no "database design," no deployment/hosting terms.

Content Quality — 42/100

- The Objective is generic boilerplate: *"I am a hard working and detail-oriented web developer who is a great team player and always willing to learn new things."* This could be pasted onto any resume for any candidate — it says nothing about Marcus specifically.
- **The core problem:** the stated target is full-stack developer, but the document is entirely WordPress/Shopify/WooCommerce freelance work. There's no backend framework, no API work, no database design, no deployment/cloud, no testing mentioned anywhere. As written, this CV supports "freelance WordPress developer," not "full-stack developer."
- "Things I Built" is the most promising section (automation tooling, a dashboard, a booking system suggest real engineering beyond theme customization) but it's described in plain-English with no tech stack, so that signal is currently invisible to a reader or an ATS.
- Personal details — **Age 28 | Single | Portuguese nationality** — add no qualification signal and read as filler at best, bias-bait at worst, in most hiring markets.
- "Also I have done several online courses about programming and design" names zero courses, platforms, or skills gained — currently worthless as a line.

Impact — 28/100

This is the lowest score on the CV, and it's the most fixable. Every bullet in the Junior Web Developer role is duty-listing, not achievement-listing:

- "Responsible for building WordPress websites for clients"
- "Was tasked with answering client emails and support requests"
- "Assisted senior developers with various tasks as needed"

None of these say what happened as a result. The Freelance paragraph is the same, plus one actively damaging line: *"it works pretty well most of the time"* — describing your own invoice tool as unreliable is a self-inflicted wound on a resume.

The good news: you already have real numbers (5 clients, 60% time saved, 2 sites) — they're just not on the page yet. See the rewrite table below.

Grammar & Spelling — 68/100

No outright typos, but consistency is off:

- Bullet symbols change within the same list: •, -, *, • all appear in the Junior Web Developer section.
- Punctuation is inconsistent between sections — "Things I Built" bullets end in periods, "Junior Web Developer" bullets don't.
- Date formatting is inconsistent: "2020-present" (no spaces) vs. "Jan 2018 – 2020" (spaced en dash).

Readability — 45/100

- The Freelance Web Developer entry is one unbroken paragraph of six-plus sentences — a recruiter skimming for 6 seconds will not read it.
- The Skills line is a 20-item comma run with no grouping, so nothing stands out.
- The bulleted Junior Web Developer section, by contrast, is genuinely easy to scan — proof the rest of the doc could be too.

Visual / Layout — 48/100

- Formatting is inconsistent between the two Experience entries: one has bullets, one doesn't.
- Low-value sections (Hobbies, "References available upon request") take up space that a full-stack candidate needs for Skills depth and a Projects tech stack.
- One page is the right length for this experience level — that part is fine.

Professionalism — 35/100

- Email: **marcus_the_dev_2000@hotmail.com** — reads as a personal handle from 2013, not a professional contact. Switch to a `firstname.lastname@` format on a modern provider.
- Age/marital status/nationality directly under the name is unusual and unnecessary for most hiring markets, including remote/international full-stack roles.
- First-person throughout ("I am," "I have," "I worked") — standard resume convention drops the subject entirely.
- Casual section headers ("Stuff I Know," "Things I Built") read like a personal blog, not an application for a full-time role.
- "References available upon request" is a dated convention — just delete it.

Deep-Dive: Technical Skills

Listed: PHP, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, WordPress, Shopify, WooCommerce, Python, MySQL, some React, Git, Photoshop, Microsoft Office, Excel, Windows and Mac, SEO, marketing.

- **"some React"** actively hurts you — hedged skills read as weaknesses, not strengths. Either state a real proficiency level or drop it until you can speak to it confidently in an interview.
- The list is platform-heavy (WordPress/Shopify/WooCommerce) and framework-light — for a full-stack target, missing pieces are conspicuous: no Node.js/Express, no Laravel or other PHP framework, no ORM, no testing framework, no cloud/hosting (AWS, Docker, etc.), no CI/CD.
- Soft skills ("communication skills, problem solving, teamwork, time management, leadership, creativity") are mixed into the technical list. Self-labeled soft skills carry near-zero weight with recruiters — cut them from this list and demonstrate them through bullet content instead.
- Photoshop, Windows and Mac, Microsoft Office/Excel are filler that dilutes an otherwise short, important list.

Recommended structure:

Category	Items
Languages	PHP, JavaScript, Python, HTML/CSS

Category	Items
Frameworks/Platforms	WordPress, Shopify, WooCommerce, [React — only if confident]
Database	MySQL
Tools	Git, [add: REST APIs, a backend framework, a deployment target]

Deep-Dive: Projects ("Things I Built")

This section has the most untapped potential on the whole CV — automation tooling, a dashboard, and a booking system are more technically interesting than the plain-English descriptions let on.

Original	Problem	Rewrite
"An online shop for a client that sells homeware. It went well and the client was happy with the result."	No tech stack, no metric, unverifiable "went well"	"Built and launched an e-commerce store for a homeware retailer using [Shopify/WooCommerce], from product catalog setup through checkout"
"A tool that gets prices from supplier websites automatically so the client doesn't have to check them manually anymore."	No stack named, no metric	"Built an automated price-scraping tool in Python that cut supplier price-checking time by 60%, eliminating a daily manual task for the client"
"A program that reads invoices and puts them into a spreadsheet, it works pretty well most of the time."	Self-undermining reliability admission	"Developed an invoice-parsing tool that automatically extracts line-item data into spreadsheets, reducing manual data entry for the client"
"A dashboard for a company to see their sales, they used to do it by hand before."	No stack, no scale	"Built a sales dashboard in [tech], replacing a manual reporting process and giving the client real-time visibility into sales data"
"A booking system for restaurants where people can reserve a table online."	No stack, no scope	"Developed an online table-reservation system for restaurant clients using [tech stack]"

Add a live link or GitHub repo for at least two of these — for a self-taught/freelance-heavy background applying to full-stack roles, a working demo does more than any bullet can.

Deep-Dive: Experience

Freelance Web Developer (2020–present) — rewrite from paragraph to bullets:

Original	Rewrite
"I have worked with many happy clients who come back to me and refer me to other people which I am proud of."	"Delivered freelance web development projects for 5 clients across Europe, earning repeat business and referrals"
"I worked on a lot of WordPress sites and also did some Shopify stores"	"Built and maintained WordPress and Shopify sites for clients, from initial build through ongoing support"
"I also wrote some scripts to automate things for clients which saved them time."	"Wrote automation scripts for clients, including a price-tracking tool that cut manual work by 60%"

Junior Web Developer, Trilha Digital (Jan 2018–2020):

Original	Problem	Rewrite
"Responsible for building WordPress websites for clients"	Passive, no scope	"Built and launched 2 production WordPress websites for clients, from design handoff to deployment"
"Helped with WooCommerce stores and fixing issues that came up"	Vague "helped"	"Resolved WooCommerce store bugs and checkout issues for client stores"
"Was tasked with answering client emails and support requests"	Passive duty-listing	"Served as primary support contact for client inquiries via email"

Original	Problem	Rewrite
"Assisted senior developers with various tasks as needed"	No substance	"Collaborated with senior developers on [feature/module] as part of a small development team"
"Participated in team meetings and contributed ideas"	Filler, no evidence	Cut, or fold into a stronger bullet if there's a specific idea that shipped

Deep-Dive: Education

Instituto Superior de Tecnologia, Web Development Diploma, 2018 — fine as-is.

"Also I have done several online courses about programming and design" — currently zero value. Either name the actual courses/certifications (platform + topic), or delete the line entirely. A named certificate (e.g., a specific Node.js or React course) would do real work toward the full-stack narrative; an unnamed vague mention does none.

Missing Sections

- **Professional Summary** — replace the generic Objective with 2-3 lines naming the target (full-stack developer), years of experience, and core stack.
- **Portfolio/GitHub link** — for a developer resume, especially one leaning on project work to prove full-stack range, a portfolio or GitHub link is close to mandatory and is currently absent entirely.
- **Certifications** (if any exist behind "several online courses") — name them.

Sections to Cut or Shrink

- **Hobbies and Interests** — low value for this application; cut to make room for Skills/Projects depth.
- **"References available upon request"** — delete; it's assumed by default now.
- **Age | Single | Portuguese nationality** — remove.

Recruiter & Hiring Manager Perspective

6-second scan: A recruiter lands on "Age 28 | Single | Portuguese nationality" directly under the name, then a cliché Objective, then a section called "Where I've Worked." Nothing in the first third of the page signals "full-stack" or shows a standout result. The visual and tonal impression is a first-draft resume, not a polished full-time application.

Hiring recommendation: As written, this would not advance to a phone screen for a full-stack, full-time role — not because the underlying work is weak (roughly 6 years of continuous freelance plus agency experience is a legitimate track record), but because the document fails to demonstrate full-stack range and reads unprofessionally in tone and formatting.

Junior vs. senior fit: Tenure (2018–present, ~6 years) suggests a mid-level candidate, but the language ("responsible for," "assisted," "was tasked with") reads junior. The resume is currently underselling the candidate's actual experience level.

Closing Synthesis

Biggest strengths:

- Genuine multi-year, multi-client freelance track record with repeat business.
- A varied project portfolio (automation, dashboards, booking systems) that's more technically interesting than a typical WordPress-only resume — currently hidden by weak descriptions.

Biggest weaknesses:

- Professionalism and tone (personal info, first-person, casual headers).
- Zero quantification on the page despite the numbers existing.
- No full-stack substance to match the stated target role.

Top 10 Improvements (by expected impact on interviews)

1. Rewrite section headers to standard terms: "Summary," "Experience," "Skills," "Projects."
2. Remove Age, marital status, and nationality from the header block.

3. Replace the generic Objective with a 2-3 line Professional Summary naming "full-stack developer" and your core stack.
4. Add the numbers you provided (5 clients, 60% time saved, 2 sites) into the matching bullets — see rewrite tables above.
5. Convert the Freelance Web Developer paragraph into 4-6 bulleted achievement statements.
6. Replace passive/weak openers ("Responsible for," "Was tasked with," "Helped with," "Assisted") with strong verbs (Built, Developed, Automated, Delivered, Resolved).
7. Cut self-undermining language like "it works pretty well most of the time."
8. Restructure Skills into categorized groups and drop soft-skill buzzwords from the technical list; resolve the "some React" hedge one way or the other.
9. Add real full-stack substance — a backend framework, API work, database design, deployment/hosting — or reframe the target toward what the experience actually supports.
10. Fix formatting consistency: one bullet symbol throughout, consistent punctuation, consistent date format; delete "References available upon request."

Quick Wins (do these in the next 10 minutes)

1. Change the email to a firstname.lastname@ format.
2. Delete the "Age | Single | Portuguese nationality" line.
3. Drop in the numbers you gave me: 5 clients, 60%, 2 sites.
4. Delete "References available upon request."
5. Pick one bullet symbol and use it everywhere.

Verdict

Marcus has real, sustained experience and a more technically interesting project history than the current document shows — but the CV as written undersells it on every axis: tone, quantification, and fit to the stated full-stack target. Fixing the quick wins alone would meaningfully improve the first impression; closing the full-stack content gap is what will actually move this into interview range.